

CirqlBreak

Port the validated circular-Breakout roguelike prototype into the Cirqlback /play route, wire it to real taps, badges, and a cross-player daily leaderboard — then decide on a standalone app.

20

issues (CHR-110 → CHR-129)

92

estimate points

5

phases + QA

~33

points to MVP-live

Why this port is cheap

A repo audit confirms the **entire reward-bridge backend is already game-agnostic and wired**: `game_progress.state` is a jsonb blob (new fields need **zero schema change**), the **tap → in-game reward hook is live** inside `processTap`, and game achievements already mint real badges via `awarderRole: "game"`. So the work is mostly a **client-engine swap** (retire ~1,300 lines of ring game, drop in the CirqlBreak canvas engine) + **catalog reshape**. The only genuinely-new build is a cross-player daily-score leaderboard.

Progress — updated 2026-07-04

P0, P1, P2 and P3 are complete — 16 of 20 issues shipped and auto-deployed live to /play. The core game, the tap→Supernova reward bridge, the cross-player Daily leaderboard, and the meta layer (cosmetic skins, achievements, galaxy map) are all live and validated in-app. Only the optional app-store track (P4) and QA remain.

Latest (playtest polish): controls redesigned into an off-field **spin dial** — the play screen is now a column with a Pulse / dial / Supernova band below the circle, so your thumb never covers the field.

P0 ✓ core

P1 ✓ reward bridge

P2 ✓ social / competitive

P3 ✓ meta & retention

P4 standalone (optional)

QA

THE WORK, BY PHASE

P0 Port the core — make /play be CirqlBreak

5 issues · 23 pts ·  Done

ID	ISSUE	SIZE	PTS
CHR-110	Extract the prototype into a TypeScript engine module Framework-agnostic engine: physics, boss, music, relics, Pulse, Supernova, 4 modes. Clean events-out / inputs-in API.	L	8
CHR-111	Rehost /play on the engine (modes, HUD, menu) React shell: mode picker, HUD, overlays, auth-aware save, CirqlBreak branding. Keeps lazy code-split.	M	5
CHR-112	Retire the ring-alignment game & Light-Ball Delete cirql-engine, pinball, worlds, world-map; strip ring vocabulary; remove /api/game/pinball.	S/M	3
CHR-113	Persist state in game_progress (no schema change) journeyBest, furthestWorld, streak, cosmetic, settings into the jsonb state blob.	S	2
CHR-114	Mobile, touch & performance pass Two-thumb Party, DPR sizing, 60fps on mid-range, iOS graceful, reduced-motion.	M	5

P1 Reward bridge — real taps → real power

4 issues · 15 pts ·  Done

ID	ISSUE	SIZE	PTS
CHR-115	Reshape the perk catalog into CirqlBreak energy/power-ups perksForTap grants Supernova charge + power-up tokens on real partner taps. Anti-abuse inherited.	M	5
CHR-116	Wire real taps → Partner Power & power-ups in-engine The money shot: tap a shop → charge a Supernova. Server-authoritative spend. "Tap to power up" onboarding.	M	5
CHR-117	Reshape achievements → mint real Cirqlback badges CirqlBreak metrics → existing awarderRole:"game" mint path → profile.	S/M	3
CHR-118	Daily reward + play-streak reconcile & surface One coherent daily loop; idempotent per UTC day; streak shown in-game + on profile.	S	2

P2 Social & competitive — make it sticky

4 issues · 18 pts ·  Done

ID	ISSUE	SIZE	PTS
CHR-122	Cross-player Daily leaderboard (new table + endpoints) The one new build: daily_scores table + guarded apply-0020 + submit/leaderboard endpoints + rank.	L	8
CHR-119	Score integrity / anti-cheat for ranked Daily Server plausibility, rate limits, run-summary signature, one ranked run/day. Deterrence, not DRM.	M	5
CHR-120	Community feed + Great Ring for CirqlBreak Reuse echoes + community counter for a live worlds-restored stat + recent-restorations feed.	S	3
CHR-121	Shareable "CirqlBreak · Daily Circle" result card Wordle-style share loop; navigator.share + clipboard fallback; rank line.	S	2

P3

Meta & retention

3 issues · 13 pts · ✓ Done

ID	ISSUE	SIZE	PTS
CHR-123	Cosmetics: paddle/ball/trail/world skins + collection UI Reshape cosmetics catalog; unlock by play + taps; equip via existing endpoint; reuse collection UI.	M	5
CHR-124	Galaxy map of restored worlds Light narrative + collection: a constellation you illuminate. Repurpose the world-map shell.	M	5
CHR-125	Achievements & mastery-challenge screen No-ball-lost clears, 100-combo, deep-world goals with progress bars → badge mint.	S	3

P4

Standalone / app store — optional track

3 issues · 18 pts · ■ Optional

ID	ISSUE	SIZE	PTS
CHR-126	PWA installability + offline solo play Manifest + service worker + "Add to Home Screen"; offline Journey/Freestyle.	M	5
CHR-127	Native app shell (Capacitor) for iOS/Android stores Native haptics, store assets, review compliance. Only if pursuing stores.	L	8
CHR-128	Accessibility & settings Colorblind palette, one-hand, aim-assist, audio/haptics/motion/difficulty — persisted.	M	5

QA

Cross-cutting

1 issue · 5 pts · ■ Ongoing

ID	ISSUE	SIZE	PTS
CHR-129	Balance, cross-device matrix & analytics Tune relics/Supernova/Party/english; device matrix; instrument tap→power-up conversion + retention. Ongoing.	M	5

WHAT IT TAKES — EFFORT & SEQUENCING

MILESTONE	SCOPE	PTS	ROUGH TIME*
MVP — live & differentiated	P0 + taps→Supernova (CHR-115/116)	33	2.5–3.5 wk
+ Full reward bridge	rest of P1	5	+0.5 wk
+ Competitive & social	P2 (leaderboard, anti-cheat, feed, share)	18	+2–2.5 wk
+ Meta & retention	P3 (cosmetics, galaxy, challenges)	13	+1.5 wk
+ App-store track	P4 (PWA / native / a11y) — optional	18	+2–3 wk

*Single developer, part-time-friendly; ~0.5–0.75 day/point. Ranges compress with focused full-time work. QA (5 pts) runs alongside every phase.

Locked decisions

- Endless-unique levels via **procedural + modifiers**, **not AI** — determinism is required for a shared Daily. AI only later for flavor (names/lore), never geometry.
- Ship **integrated in /play first** (fastest to real users + the reward bridge); evaluate standalone app after.
- The reward bridge is the **moat** — nobody else does "tap a coffee shop → multiball."

Risks & watch-items

- **Daily leaderboard** is the only net-new backend + the one needing a **guarded DDL apply-script** (db:migrate is broken on the shared DB).
- **Client is untrusted** — anti-cheat is pragmatic deterrence, not DRM.
- **iOS Safari** has no web haptics — degrade gracefully; native shell (P4) restores it.
- **Party co-op** needs real two-human playtesting to tune.